Menstrual cycle

Each month women of reproductive age who are not pregnanat go through a cycle of fertility that results in either pregnanacy or menstrual cycle
The average menstrual cycle is 28 days
Day 1-5(menstrual phase)

- ✓ First day of womens period is considered as first day of the menstrual cycle
- ✓ If egg is not fertilized it disintegrates
- ✓ Low levels of estrogen and progesterone causes the endometrium to breakdown and shed in the form of blood
- ✓ In average it lasts for 5 days

Day 1-13(follicular phase)

- ✓ Early in the menstrual cycle the pituitary gland in the brain producis rising amount of follicle stimulating hormone
- ✓ Which promote the development of several follicles each one containing an egg in ovaries
- ✓ But only one follicle reach maturity
- ✓ At the end of this phase ovaries secrete increasing levels of estrogen
- ✓ This causes thickening of uterine lining in preparation for a fertilized egg

Day 10-18(ovulatory phase)

- ✓ The pituitary gland and hypothalamus release high levels of lutenizing hormone(LH)
- ✓ This causes mature follicle to bulge out of the ovary and burst releasing egg, a process called ovulation
- ✓ Ovulation usually occurs around day 14 of the cycle
- ✓ The egg than travels through fallopian tubes into the uterus
- ✓ This is the time a women is most likely to become pregnanat

Day 15-28(leutal phase)

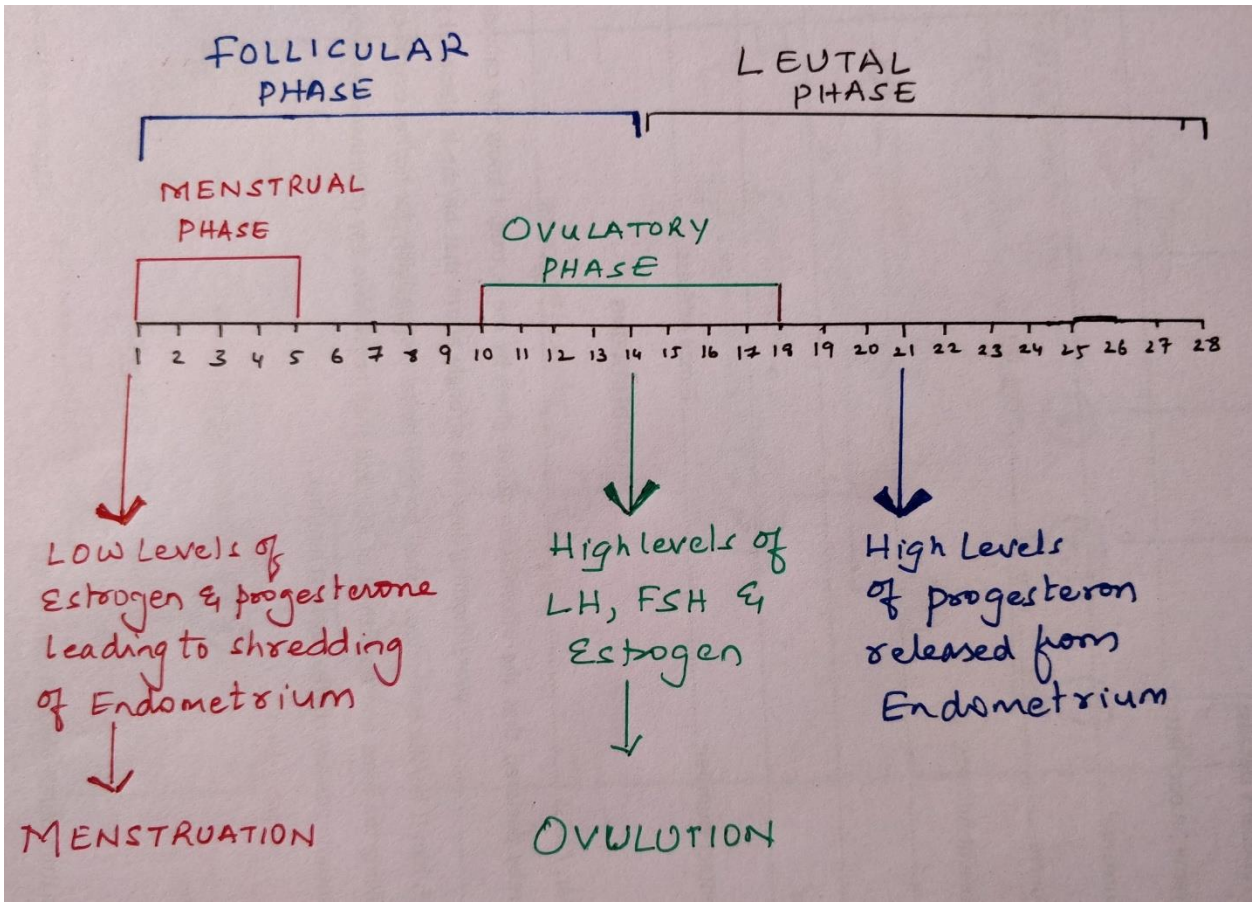
- ✓ After releasing egg the ruptured follicle develops into corpus luteum
- ✓ Which secretes increased amounts of progesterone
- ✓ The progesterone causes the endometrium to thicken further, which support embryonic development

If the egg is fertilized

- ✓ The corpus luteum begins to produce human chorionic gandotropin
- ✓ Which maintain corpus luteum and progesterone secretion
- ✓ The egg moves to uterus and attaches to endometrium after 6-7 days of ovulation
- ✓ This begin to develop into fetus

If the egg is not fertilized

- ✓ The corpus luteum degenerated after about 14 days
- ✓ The levels of estrogen and progesterone drop
- ✓ This causesendometrium to break down and shed and new menstrual cycle begins


FOLLICULAR PHASE
LEUTAL PHASE
MENSTRUAL PHASE
OVULATORY PHASE
1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28
LOW Levels of Estrogen & progesterone leading to shredding of Endometrium
MENSTRUATION
High levels of LH, FSH & Estrogen
OVULUTION
High Levels of progesteron released from Endometrium